

“Okay, Andrea, let’s go for it. You pack some things, and I’ll call my parents and let them know.”

Andrea panicked inside as Bill mentioned calling his mom. “Please don’t tell anyone right now,” she pleaded. “They’ll just try to talk us out of it. I want this to be our surprise. We’ll tell them after graduation. Okay?”

Bill agreed reluctantly. He knew his mom would be hurt when she found out. Andrea said, “Let’s just go like we are. We don’t need any extra clothes. We’ll only be gone two days at the most, and we can buy something if we really need it.”

By this time Bill was totally into the idea as well, so he replied, “This is really crazy, but if that’s what you want, we’ll do it. At least we’ll have something to tell our grandchildren.”

Andrea grabbed Bill around the waist. “We’re going to be so happy, Bill. I just know it.”

Bill and Andrea took off for Virginia. Four hours later they stopped to eat a very late dinner. While they were eating, they mentioned to the motherly waitress that they were driving to Virginia to get married the next day.

“Do you have your license yet?” she asked.

“No,” Bill replied. “We understand we don’t have to wait in Virginia.”

“Well, I don’t know who told you that, honey,” she said in a charming Southern drawl. “But it simply ain’t true. You gotta wait at least two days.”

“We can’t wait,” Andrea said in alarm. “We have to be back in school Monday morning.”

“Well, I’d suggest you go to New Jersey then,” the waitress said authoritatively. “You don’t have to wait at all up there. That’s where we got married a few years back.”

“We can’t drive all the way to New Jersey,” Bill argued. “It would take ten or twelve more hours.”